



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 39

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Tool Storage & Inventory Control

OVERVIEW:

Proper tool storage at the end of every shift is a safety practice that prevents multiple categories of injury. Unsecured tools on elevated surfaces are drop hazards. Sharp tools stored loosely cause lacerations when someone reaches into a bag or box. Missing tools create pressure to improvise — and

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. At the end of every shift, every tool comes off every elevated surface. Every scaffold plank, every window sill, every ladder tray, every cabinet top. This is a non-negotiable rule because a tool left on an elevated surface at quitting time is a drop hazard for the night cleaning crew, the next trade through the area, or the first worker into the area the next morning. The height that seemed
2. Sharp tools — chisels, router bits, saw blades, and utility knife assemblies — must be stored with their edges protected. This protects the edge itself from damage and protects every hand that reaches into the storage area from contact with an unprotected edge. Use blade guards, blade rolls, blade tubes, or dedicated storage slots. A loose chisel in a tool bag can cause a serious
3. Tool inventory at the end of the shift serves two purposes: accountability and safety. Missing tools need to be found before they become a hazard to someone else, and a missing tool discovered the next morning typically means a longer delay than one discovered at the end of the previous shift. Develop a quick end-of-shift inventory habit — it takes two minutes and prevents significant
4. Damaged tools must be removed from service and tagged immediately — not set back in the tool bag with the intention of reporting later. A tagged tool communicates clearly to every other person on the crew that this item is not safe to use. A cracked drill body, a bent extension cord prong, a chipped saw blade, and a damaged nailer safety tip are all legitimate tags. When in doubt, tag it

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: Is every tool on this job currently in serviceable condition? Are there any tools that need to be tagged out?
Q2: Walk through our end-of-shift tool storage procedure — where does everything go?

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Store all sharp tools (chisels, router bits, blades) with guards or in rolls
- Never leave tools on scaffolding, ladders, or elevated surfaces between uses
- Conduct a tool inventory at the end of each shift
- Damaged tools must be tagged OUT OF SERVICE and removed immediately
- Report tool theft immediately — missing tools create both budget and safety issues

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 39

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)	#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)
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